



Palawan, 27 to 31 Dec: pick our adventure

4 ways to spend the 4 days between Manila and Boracay New Year's Eve, each scored on real review data, with proven reviews and a proven lively group counting most. My pick is now the Coron → El Nido boat trip 🚤: it's the best reviewed and has the most proven social groups.



SAT 26 DEC

Sydney ✈️ Manila

Lands 6:05pm • Poblacion night out 🎉

BOOKED



SUN 27 DEC

Manila ✈️ Puerto Princesa

3:30 → 4:55pm

Non-refundable • ~A\$93 each

BOOKED



THU 31 DEC

El Nido (Lio) ✈️ Caticlan

2:45 → 3:50pm • Boracay NYE

🕒 At Lio airport by 1:15pm

BOOKED

👁️ The 4 options at a glance

Tap one to jump to its card. Prices are A\$ per person. 📊 = weighted evidence score out of 50 (how we scored).

NEW UNPROVEN

1 • Port Barton → El Nido

3-day boat trip, beach tents

~A\$700–750 each

📊 21/50

★ MY PICK

2 • Coron → El Nido

Famous boat trip via Clark

~A\$850–1,050 each

📊 43/50 🏆

🥈 RUNNER-UP

3 • Stay in El Nido

Surf, day boat, hostels

~A\$450–700 each

📊 38/50

👎 NOT RECOMMENDED

A • Yohak Linapacan

Glamping, new operator

~A\$900–950 each

📊 22/50

Where each option goes

All four routes with their costs. Open the web page for the interactive map with photos.



1 • Port Barton → El Nido

PPS → Port Barton → 3 days → El Nido
~A\$700-750

★ 2 • Coron → El Nido

Clark → Coron → 3 days → El Nido
~A\$850-1,050

3 • Stay in El Nido

PPS → El Nido → Nacpan → day trip
~A\$450-700

A • Yohak Linapacan

El Nido → Linapacan → Parada → BACK
~A\$900-950

All options end with Lio → Boracay on 31 Dec

Legend:
 - - - Flight
 — Road
 Boat

Grey dashed = already-booked flights

Dashed pin border = approximate spot



The options, one by one

Every dot now comes from a rule (see [How we scored](#)) and the key number behind it is shown under it. More dots is better; for Logistics, more dots = safer.

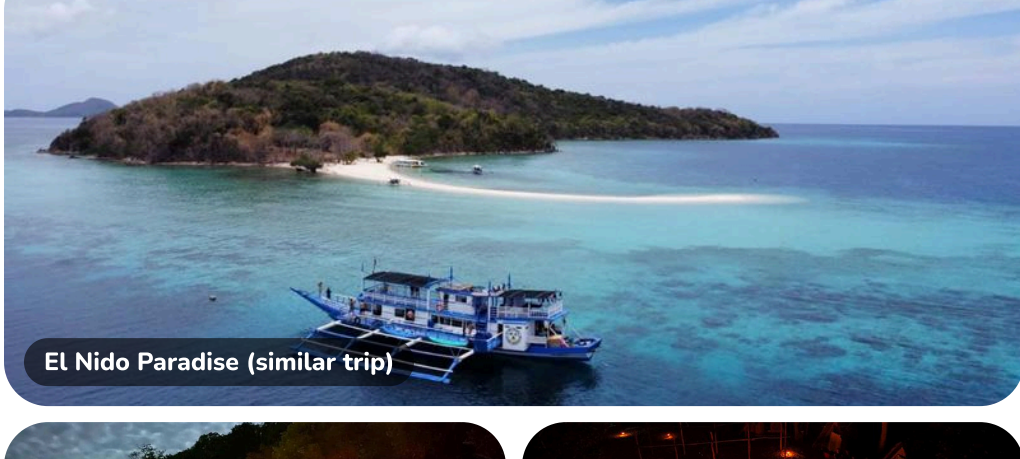
NEW UNPROVEN · NO REVIEWS YET

1

Port Barton → El Nido boat trip

El Nido Paradise · 3-day expedition

~A\$700–750 A\$ per person, all in



El Nido Paradise (similar trip)



El Nido Paradise (similar trip)



El Nido Paradise (similar trip)

✓ Keeps all flights

☀️ Calmer west coast in Dec

NEW 17 28 Dec shown available

NEW New route: 0 reviews, group unproven

27 SUN



Land PPS, van to Port Barton

~3–3.5h · arrive ~8:30–9pm · hotel

28 MON



Boat trip starts

Port Barton turtles

29 TUE



Long Beach + Malampaya Sound

Beach-camp tents

30 WED



South Bacuit → El Nido

Arrive ~4:30pm · hotel

31 THU



Free morning

Lio airport by 1:15pm

💰 Tour ₱18,900 (~A\$423) + van ~A\$100 + rooms ~A\$170

🏕️ Tents with bedding, showers and toilets

👥 Up to 18 guests

July 17 One of only 4 December departures (other dates full)

★ Operator: Tripadvisor 4.9 (1,317) · Google 4.8 (2,097). This route: 0 reviews (new)

The catch: zero reviews of this route and no proof of a lively group yet (it launches Oct 2026), and it's tents. It fits our flights best, but that isn't enough on our top two criteria.



Evidence score

21/50

Weighted: reviews and social count ×3 · unweighted 17/30



Social ×3

1/5 ticks on its own evidence: a shared group (up to 18). No reviews, so the group is unproven. (The Coron proxy would tick 5/5, but proxies are not scored.)



Scenery

3 days along the remote west coast, but the route is new with no guest reviews



Sleep

Beach tents with mats and bedding; no reviews of these camps yet



Logistics (safer)

1 flag: new route. Flights kept, sheltered west coast, ends a day before the flight



Review strength ×3

0 reviews of this route (it launches Oct 2026). Operator-wide 3,400+ at 4.8–4.9 shown, not counted



Value

~A\$725 midpoint scores 4, +1 because all 3 boat days are catered



The evidence

checked 28 Sep 2026

This route is new (it launches this October), so there are **no reviews of it yet**, and it is scored only on that. Everything under the PROXY label comes from the same operator's Coron route (the same boats and crews since 2015). It is shown for context and **is not scored**.

NEW This route

0

reviews

Operator product page: "There are no reviews yet"

Route videos

0

found

No YouTube videos of the Port Barton route yet

Tripadvisor

4.9

1,317 reviews

Operator-wide. From a search snippet, because Tripadvisor blocks us

Google Maps

4.8

2,097 reviews

Operator-wide

PROXY Coron route data (same operator, same boats and crews)

Operator site

5.00

17 reviews

Coron → El Nido product (2017 to Nov 2024)

Operator site

4.96

27 reviews

El Nido → Coron product (2016 to Jan 2025)

🔪 We read **49 reviews**: all 44 on the operator's site plus the 5 that Google shows when you're not signed in. Only **7 of 49 (14%)** are from **2025–26**; Tripadvisor's recent reviews were blocked.

👥 Praise the group, people or vibe

39% 19/49

😬 Say quiet, too young or too old

0% 0/49

👤 Praise the crew or guide

84% 41/49

😬 Sleep or facility complaints

4% 2/49

🌊 Weather cancellations reported

0% 0/49

👥 **Group size:** 15 guests + 9 crew (Google, 2026) · 15 (Jan 2025) · 18 (2019) · about 18 + 5 crew (blog, 2020). The cap is 18.

🎂 **Age mix:** "quite mixed in age and nationality" (Tripadvisor) · "a mix of couples and adult families" (Google, 2026) · "several nationalities, diff ages" (2019).

🌊 **Weather:** no cancellations in the reviews. One 2018 trip swapped stops when they couldn't anchor. A 2020 blog mentions a choppy day and a skipped cliff jump. The operator's policy is to reschedule, give credit or refund in full.

"Our tour group, of a small number only 15 ... All 15 of us guests were very sad to leave the boat trip ... making friends with all other guests but also all the crew."

Isabel C., operator site (El Nido → Coron), 26 Jan 2025

"There was a good mix of nationalities and ages on the boat. A few couples, a few groups of friends, solo travellers and a mother and son."

Irish on the Run blog (Coron route), Apr 2020

🌐 See the real website

Trip schedule

Private van ₱9,100/van

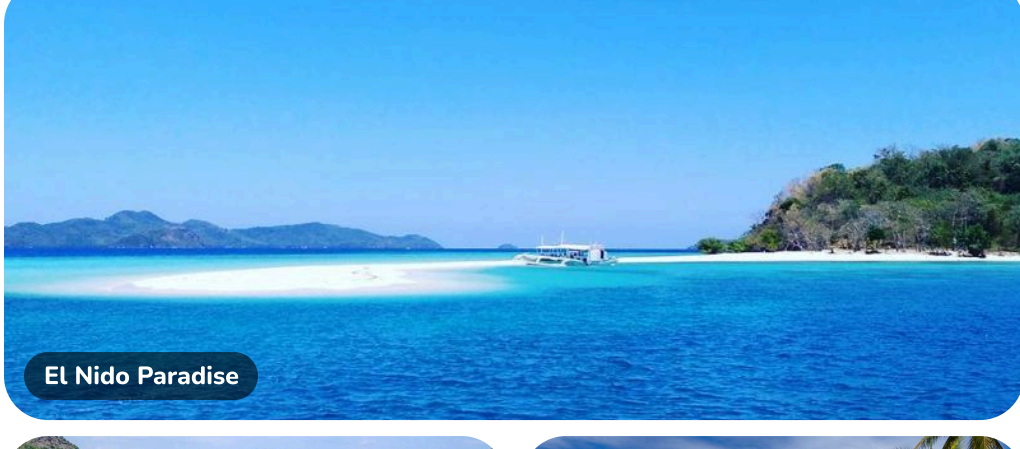
★ MY PICK · MOST PROVEN

2

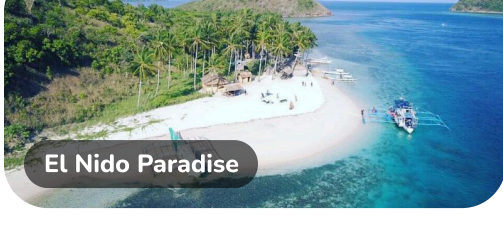
Coron → El Nido boat trip

Fly Clark → Coron · El Nido Paradise flagship

~A\$850–1,050 A\$ per person, all in



El Nido Paradise



El Nido Paradise



Linapacan · El Nido Paradise

✗ Drop PPS flight (lose ~A\$93)

🏆 Travelers' Choice

🎉 Liveliest groups

🛫 Seats unconfirmed

27 SUN



Manila → Clark → Coron

Leave by ~11:30am · DG5293 2:30 → 3:55pm or PR2678 3 → 4:10pm

28 MON



Boat trip starts

Culion

29 TUE



Ditaytayan sandbar

Linapacan · nipa huts

30 WED



Arrive El Nido

~5pm

31 THU



Free morning

Lio airport by 1:15pm



Tour ₱21,900 (~A\$490) + flights + hotels



Beach nipa huts



The most famous trip, best scenery



Early start after the Manila night out



Coron route: 5.00 from 17 reviews on the operator site; the operator has 3,400+ reviews



The catch: we give up the booked PPS flight (~A\$93 each) and add a Clark → Coron flight, an early start after the Manila night out, a windier crossing, and seats unconfirmed.



Evidence score

43/50

Weighted: reviews and social count x3 · unweighted 23/30



Social x3



5/5 ticks: groups of about 15, 39% praise the group, mixed ages, 0% say quiet



Scenery



3 days through Culion and Linapacan, on the reviewed flagship route



Sleep



Nipa huts with bedding and nets; 2 of 49 reviews complain (4%)



Logistics (safer)



3 flags: extra Clark to Coron flight (and the booked PPS flight is lost), an exposed crossing, seats unconfirmed



Review strength x3



Tripadvisor 4.9 (1,317) and Google 4.8 (2,097), with 2026 reviews; route pages 5.00 (17) and 4.96 (27)



Value



~A\$950 midpoint scores 2, +1 because it is catered



The evidence

checked 28 Sep 2026



Tripadvisor



4.9

1,317 reviews

Travelers' Choice 2026. From a search snippet (the page blocks us)



Google Maps



4.8

2,097 reviews

Operator-wide · 2026 reviews visible



Operator site



5.00

17 reviews

Coron → El Nido product (2017 to Nov 2024)



Operator site



4.96

27 reviews

El Nido → Coron product (2016 to Jan 2025)



We read **49 reviews**: all 44 on the operator's site plus the 5 that Google shows when you're not signed in. Only **7 of 49 (14%)** are from **2025–26**; Tripadvisor's recent reviews were blocked.



Praise the group, people or vibe



0% 0/49

0% 0/49

0% 0/49

84% 41/49

84% 41/49

4% 2/49

4% 2/49

0% 0/49

0% 0/49

Group size: 15 guests + 9 crew (Google, 2026) · 15 (Jan 2025) · 18 (2019) · about 18 + 5 crew (blog, 2020). The cap is 18.

Age mix: "quite mixed in age and nationality" (Tripadvisor) · "a mix of couples and adult families" (Google, 2026) · "several nationalities, diff ages" (2019).

Weather: no cancellations in the reviews. One 2018 trip swapped stops when they couldn't anchor. A 2020 blog mentions a choppy day and a skipped cliff jump. The operator's policy is to reschedule, give credit or refund in full.

Creator content: 11 creator videos + 3 of the operator's own on YouTube; the newest creator video is about 2 years old. TikTok @elnidoparadise: 42 videos, 166 followers. Instagram: login wall, not checked.

“There were 15 of us on the boat and 9 crew members.”

Mónika D., Google Maps, ~5 months ago (≈Apr 2026) [↗](#)

“You bond so quickly with everyone on the boat because you spend three full days together.”

Carmen, Google Maps, ~4 months ago (≈May 2026) [↗](#)

“Groups that are quite mixed in age and nationality... Other companies are ... very party-oriented, which is not the case here, although, no worries, the atmosphere is lively!”

Tripadvisor review (date not visible; from a search snippet) [↗](#)

“The tour guide and the team were very nice and helpful and the group was also pretty cool.”

r/Philippines_Expats comment on El Nido Paradise (search snippet; date not shown) [↗](#)



See the real website

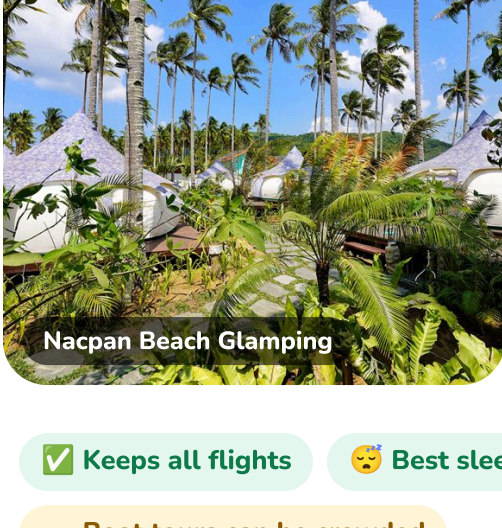


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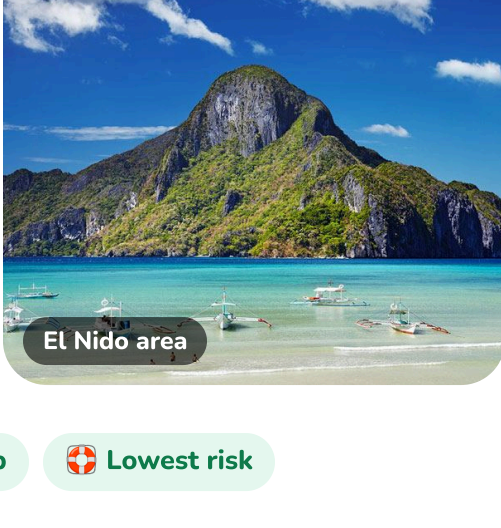
Stay in El Nido, land-based

Surf, a boat day, social hostels

~**A\$450–700** A\$ per person, all in



Nacpan Beach Glamping



El Nido area

 **Keeps all flights**

 **Best sleep**

 **Lowest risk**

 **Boat tours can be crowded**

27 SUN



Land PPS, drive to El Nido

Van or private car · arrive ~11pm

28 MON



Nacpan surf lesson

Nacpan Beach Glamping or Mad Monkey Nacpan

29 TUE



Island-hopping day

Tour A lagoons · shared or private

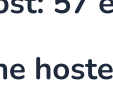
30 WED



Outpost Beach Hostel

Private ensuite · sunset social

31 THU



Free morning

Lio airport by 1:15pm

 **Real beds every night: air-con glamping, then a private ensuite**

 **Outpost: 57 events listed, 35% of reviews praise the vibe**

 **But the hostel crowds skew young: 80% of Outpost reviewers are 30 or under**

 **Flexible: change plans day by day**

The catch: less of an adventure, Tour A is crowded, and the hostel crowd is mostly in their 20s. Choose Nacpan Glamping over Mad Monkey (no air-con, 0% of sampled reviewers 31+).



Evidence score

38/50

Weighted: reviews and social count x3 · unweighted 24/30



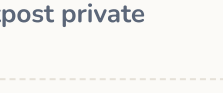
Social x3



3/5 ticks (Outpost night): events + 35% praise the vibe; but no shared group, and only 20% of reviewers are 31+



Scenery



One Tour A day on the busy lagoon circuit + Nacpan beach



Sleep



Nacpan Glamping air-con praised in 8 of 30 reviews; Outpost private ensuite



Logistics (safer)



0 flags: flights kept, no open-water crossing, day-by-day flexibility



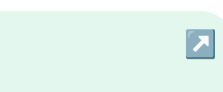
Review strength x3



Each stay has 1,000+ reviews, but the weighted averages are 4.59–4.65 (below the 4.7 needed for 5)



Value



~A\$575 midpoint; meals not included



The evidence

checked 28 Sep 2026



Nacpan Beach Glamping

Night 1 · recommended



Booking.com



8.9

702 reviews



Google



4.6

700 reviews



Tripadvisor



4.8

634 reviews

As shown on Google



Latest 30 Booking.com reviews (18 May to 8 Sep 2026; all from 2026): 47% couples, 23% solo, 20% groups, 10% families.



Praise the air-con

27% 8/30



Thin walls or noise

3% 1/30



Mention a social vibe

3% 1/30



Scored below 7/10

7% 2/30

“Huge, aircon tents with comfy mattresses ... with 35 degrees outside!”

Booking.com, 23 May 2026 

“Tent walls are basically just fabric ... if you are a really light sleeper ... bring some earplugs.”

Emily (Australia), Booking.com, 3 Aug 2026 



Mad Monkey Nacpan

Night 1 · alternative



Hostelworld



9.4

1,856 reviews



Google



4.4

1,352 reviews



Tripadvisor



4.7

516 reviews

As shown on Google



Latest 30 Hostelworld reviews (May to Aug 2026, the wet low season). **Reviewer ages: 18–24: 57% · 25–30: 43% · 31+: 0%.**



Praise the vibe or events

20% 6/30



Say quiet or dead (low season)

27% 8/30



No-air-con complaints

17% 5/30



Mention bad weather

10% 3/30

“If it had AC it would be the nest [best] hostel I would have stayed in on my trip so far.”

Male 25–30 (Australia), Hostelworld, Jun 2026 

“Really quiet right now. But apart from that was great.”

Female 18–24, Hostelworld, Jul 2026 



Outpost Beach Hostel

Night 3 · the social night



Hostelworld



9.5

3,075 reviews

Atmosphere 9.8



Booking.com



8.6

484 reviews



Google



4.5

683 reviews



Tripadvisor



4.5

201 reviews

As shown on Google



Latest 30 Hostelworld reviews (Jun to Sep 2026) + latest 30 Booking.com reviews (May to Sep 2026; 73% solo travellers). Hostelworld has **57 events** listed: karaoke, game night, beer pong, beach party.



Praise the vibe, people or events

35% 21/60



Say it's too young for 30-somethings

2% 1/60



Noise complaints (music, construction)

5% 3/60



Praise the staff

77% 23/30

“They had a pool party, trivia and karaoke.”

Female 31–40 (USA), Hostelworld, Aug 2026 

“The average age is veryyyy young, think late teens to early 20s ... if you are looking for a more mature hostel (late 20s–early to mid 30s) this is not the vibe.”

Solo traveller, Booking.com, 24 Jun 2026 



El Nido Tour A (day trip)

Day 3



GetYourGuide



4.5

7 reviews

One listing (2025–26). Dozens of agencies sell Tour A, so there is no single review base.



YouTube

8

of top 20 results

Tour A videos with up to 1.1M views



Crowding is the common complaint about Tour A on Reddit and travel blogs.

“On the El Nido tour some stops we couldn't even make because there wasn't enough boat parking. It felt a little instagram vs reality.”

r/Philippines_Expats comment (search snippet; date not shown) 



See the real website



Outpost Beach Hostel 

👉 NOT RECOMMENDED

A

Yohak Linapacan return trip

From El Nido · 2 nights glamping at Parada Beach Camp

~A\$900–950 A\$ per person, all in



Parada Beach Camp · Yohak



Glamping tent · Yohak



Yohak boat

✓ Keeps all flights

🛖 Glamping: beds, fans, pool

NEW Launched April 2026

🌊 Rougher sea in Dec

27 SUN Land PPS, van to El Nido



Arrive late

28 MON Meet 7:30am at Lio



Boat to Linapacan · Parada night 1

29 TUE Parada Beach Camp



Glamping night 2

30 WED Back to El Nido



31 THU Free morning



Lio airport by 1:15pm

💰 ₱28,000 (~A\$626) + private tent ~A\$89 + fees ~A\$25

★ Camp: 9.5/10 from 114 Booking.com reviews. Yohak itself: 0 reviews

🚿 16 of 18 seats free

👤 One-person business, needs 4 guests to run



The catch: brand-new one-person business with no independent reviews, needs 4 guests to run, and a rougher sea on that side in December (Yohak itself says March to May is best).

Evidence score

22/50

Weighted: reviews and social count x3 · unweighted 16/30

🎉 Social x3



3 ticks (shared boat, evening events, no "quiet" complaints) –1 because only 2 of 18 seats were booked

🌴 Scenery



Linapacan waters, but only 2 boat days (out and back)

😴 Sleep



Glamping tents with fans from 9pm to 6am; heat mentioned in 2 of 30 reviews (7%)

🚦 Logistics (safer)



3 flags: operator launched April 2026, exposed east-side crossing, below the 4-guest minimum

★ Review strength x3



Yohak has 0 reviews on Google and none elsewhere (Parada camp on its own would score 3)

💰 Value



~A\$925 midpoint scores 2, +1 because it is catered

The evidence

checked 28 Sep 2026

🍷 Yohak on Google



0

reviews

Listing exists, no rating yet

🌐 Yohak website



2

testimonials

Undated. One says: "This might be their first review"

🟦 Parada · Booking



9.5

114 reviews

Up from 9.4/77 on our last check

📍 Parada · Google



4.3

25 reviews

Tripadvisor listings shown there: 3.7 (3) and 3.0 (2)

🟠 Parada · Hostelworld



9.3

2 reviews

🖋 Latest 30 Parada reviews on Booking.com (10 Jan to 16 May 2026): **77% couples**, 13% groups, 10% solo. There were no new Booking.com reviews after 16 May.

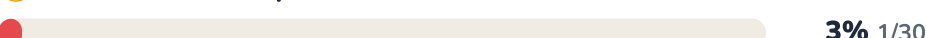
🎉 Mention a (chill) vibe



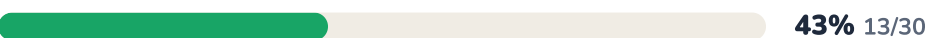
😓 Tents hot by day (fan OK at night)



😐 "We were the only ones there"



👤 Praise the staff or hosts



🎬 **Creator content:** 0 YouTube videos for Yohak or Parada. TikTok and Instagram: not found.

🌊 **Weather:** Yohak's own Linapacan page says the best time is "March to May (crucial for calm crossings)".

“We were a little nervous booking Yohak since they were brand new and didn't have any reviews yet.”

Testimonial on the Yohak website (undated) [↗](#)

“We were the only ones there so had the whole place for ourself ... Take a book (or 2) with you here because there is little to do.”

Couple, Booking.com (Parada), 20 Jan 2026 [↗](#)

“The tents are comfortable, but can get very hot during the day.”

Conor D., Google Maps (Parada), ~1 year ago [↗](#)

🌐 See the real website [↗](#)



How we scored

Six metrics, each from 1 to 5 dots, with the same thresholds for every option. Every number was checked on 28 Sep 2026.

 **The weighting (your top two criteria count x3)**

 **Review strength x3**

 **Social x3**

 **Scenery x1**

 **Sleep x1**

 **Logistics x1**

 **Value x1**

Weighted score = ∑ (dots × weight), out of 50. Proven reviews + a proven social group = 30 of the 50 points. The unweighted /30 total is shown too.

1 · Collect



Ratings and counts from Tripadvisor, Google Maps, Booking.com, Hostelworld, GetYourGuide and the operators' own sites.

2 · Sample



The latest 30–60 reviews for each place (49 for the boat operator), coded for social, sleep, crew and weather.

3 · Apply the key



Thresholds below, then weight them. Proxy data is shown but never scored.

Metric	Weight	    	    	    	    	    
		1	2	3	4	5
 Social Checklist: 1 point for each tick (minimum score 1). Only reviews of this exact trip or stay count. - Shared group: the same people for the days (not just a hostel) - Nightly group events (bonfire, socials, games) ≥30% of sampled reviews praise the group, people or vibe - Age fit: ≥25% of reviewers aged 31+, or reviewers describe a mixed-age crowd <10% of sampled reviews say quiet, dead or too young –1 if fewer than 4 people are booked when last checked	x3	0–1 points	2 points	3 points	4 points	5 points
 Scenery What you actually see, based on the route.	x1	Mostly transit	Beach or land only, no boat days	1 boat day on the busy El Nido circuit + beach days	2–3 days in remote waters, but the route is new or has fewer boat days	3 days at sea through Linapacan/Culion with remote camps, on a route past guests have reviewed
 Sleep Bed quality and heat. December nights are about 24–27°C.	x1	No bedding, or no data	Shared beach tents with mats, or dorms; or heat/noise complaints ≥15%	Beach nipa huts with bedding and nets, no air-con; complaints <10%	Private glamping tent or room with fans; heat complaints <15%	Private air-con room or tent, and reviews praise the air-con
 Logistics risk More dots = safer. Start at 5 and lose 1 for each red flag: ① new or unreviewed operator/route ② needs an extra flight or gives up a booked one ③ open-water crossing exposed to the December north-east monsoon (amihan) ④ seats or minimum numbers unconfirmed ⑤ less than 18 hours before a flight.	x1	4+ flags	3 flags	2 flags	1 flag	0 flags
 Review strength Across platforms; /10 scores are halved to /5. A score of 4+ needs reviews from the last 12 months. If the exact trip has no reviews it scores 1: operator-wide reviews are shown but not counted.	x3	<10 reviews	10–49 reviews, or average <4.2	50+ reviews averaging ≥4.2	200+ reviews averaging ≥4.5	1,000+ reviews averaging ≥4.7 on 2+ platforms
 Value Midpoint of the all-in A\$ per person (tour, transfers, rooms, flight changes). +1 if at least 2 days are fully catered (meals and drinks included). Maximum 5.	x1	over A\$1,050	A\$901–1,050	A\$751–900	A\$551–750	A\$550 or less

Only evidence about the exact trip or stay counts. Proxy data (for example, El Nido Paradise's Coron route for the new Port Barton route) is shown in the evidence panels, clearly labelled PROXY, but it is never scored. The review samples are the latest reviews we could reach on each platform, coded by keyword and then checked by hand. Only English keywords were matched, so a few reviews in other languages may be undercounted.



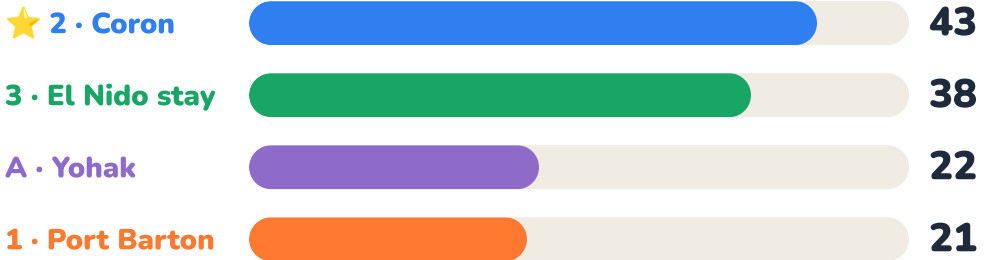
Side by side

Green = 4–5 dots, yellow = 3, red = 1–2. The small print is the key number behind each score.

	1 Port Barton	★ 2 Coron	3 El Nido stay	A Yohak
✈ Flights kept	✓ All	✗ Drop PPS flight lose ~A\$93 each	✓ All	✓ All
💰 A\$ each	~700–750	~850–1,050	~450–700	~900–950
🎉 Social x3	● ○ ○ ○ ○ unproven: 0 reviews	● ● ● ● ● ~15 guests, 39% praise	● ● ● ○ ○ 20% of reviewers 31+	● ● ○ ○ ○ 2 of 18 booked
🌴 Scenery	● ● ● ● ○ new route	● ● ● ● ● Linapacan + Culion	● ● ● ○ ○ busy Tour A	● ● ● ● ○ 2 boat days
😴 Sleep	● ● ○ ○ ○ tents	● ● ● ○ ○ nipa huts	● ● ● ● ● air-con, ensuite	● ● ● ● ○ glamping, fans
🚢 Logistics (safer)	● ● ● ● ○ 1 flag: new route	● ● ○ ○ ○ 3 flags	● ● ● ● ● 0 flags	● ● ○ ○ ○ 3 flags
★ Review strength x3	● ○ ○ ○ ○ 0 route reviews	● ● ● ● ● 3,400+ at 4.8–4.9	● ● ● ● ○ 1,000+ each, 4.6	● ○ ○ ○ ○ Yohak: 0
💰 Value	● ● ● ● ● ~A\$725, catered	● ● ● ○ ○ ~A\$950, catered	● ● ● ● ○ ~A\$575	● ● ● ○ ○ ~A\$925, catered
📏 Weighted /50	21	43 🏆	38	22
Unweighted /30	17	23	24	16



What the evidence says



Weighted evidence score out of 50 (reviews and social x3)

New pick: ★ Option 2, Coron → El Nido. It is the only option that is proven on both of our top criteria: 3,400+ operator-wide reviews at 4.8–4.9, plus groups of about 15, with 39% of sampled reviews praising the group and none calling it quiet. It scores 43/50. The cost: we give up the booked PPS flight (~A\$93 each), add a Clark → Coron flight, and the crossing is more exposed. Seats still need confirming.

Runner-up: Option 3 (38). It is well reviewed and the safest, but the social side is hostel-based and skews young (only 20% of Outpost reviewers are 31+). If we choose it, pick Nacpan Beach Glamping over Mad Monkey.

Option 1 drops to last (21). Scored on its own evidence, the new route has 0 reviews and an unproven group. It's still the best fit for our flights, and the Coron-route proxy looks good, but proxies don't count here. **Option A (22)** is still not recommended.



What we need to decide

1



Agree with SJ: Option 2?

Proven reviews and a proven group, at the cost of one lost flight. Option 3 is the fallback.

2



Check Coron seats + flights

Seats on the 28 Dec Coron → El Nido departure, and Clark → Coron fares on 27 Dec (DG5293 / PR2678). Nothing booked yet.

3



Then book

Tour deposit (30%), the Coron flight and a Coron hotel for 27 Dec. For option 3 instead: a van from Puerto Princesa.



What we couldn't verify:

- Any reviews of the new Port Barton route (it launches Oct 2026). It is scored on its own (lack of) evidence; the Coron-route proxy is shown, not scored.
- Tripadvisor pages (blocked to us): the counts shown come from search snippets and Google's "reviews from the web" panel, and we couldn't sample recent Tripadvisor reviews.
- Reddit (blocked): we only saw search-engine snippets of threads, not full threads or dates.
- Instagram (login wall) and TikTok hashtag counts (not shown when logged out). Google only shows 5 reviews when you're not signed in.
- Group size and ages on our actual dates, December fares for Clark → Coron, and New Year hotel prices.

"~" means an estimate. Peso prices converted at about ₱1 = A\$0.0224. Map pins marked approximate are close, not exact. Map © OpenStreetMap contributors. Raw review captures are saved in the research folder.